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## HACKATHON CHALLENGE

# Empowering the Everyday Investor

## CHALLENGE TITLE

*Navigating the Unknown: Intuitive Portfolio Management & Dynamic Rebalancing for the Everyday Investor*

## 2. BACKGROUND & CONTEXT

In recent years, retail participation in equity markets and mutual funds has surged. However, the majority of financial tools are designed for seasoned traders and market professionals. They are often cluttered with complex charts, financial jargon, and opaque metrics. When global uncertainties arise—such as geopolitical tensions, inflation spikes, or sudden market downturns—novice investors often panic or make uninformed decisions. They lack clear, actionable guidance on how to protect their wealth or adjust their investments to align with their evolving personal lives.

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## 3. THE CHALLENGE

Design and build a comprehensive, user-friendly Stock and Mutual Fund portfolio management system tailored specifically for non-market-savvy individuals. The platform must demystify wealth management, allowing users to easily track their investments, understand their risk exposure, and seamlessly rebalance their portfolios in response to changing personal needs or

uncertain macroeconomic scenarios.

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#### 4. TARGET AUDIENCE

**The Beginner Retail Investor:** Individuals who want to grow their wealth and participate in the markets but lack the time, expertise, or confidence to actively manage their portfolios using traditional, complex brokerage platforms.

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#### 5. CORE REQUIREMENTS & FEATURES

To successfully solve this challenge, student teams must incorporate the following elements into their prototypes:

##### **Unified & Intuitive Dashboard**

Create a seamless interface that aggregates both stocks and mutual funds. The design must be jargon-free, utilizing plain language and clear visual indicators (e.g., portfolio health scores, simple risk meters, color-coded asset allocation) instead of overwhelming data tables.

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##### **Scenario-Driven Rebalancing Engine**

The system must help users navigate uncertainty. It should offer simple “What-If” scenarios (e.g., “What if the market drops by 20%?”, “What if inflation stays high?”, or “What if I need to withdraw 20% of my funds next year?”). Based on the user’s selection, the platform should recommend a clear, easy-to-execute rebalancing strategy.

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##### **Radical Transparency**

The platform must clearly explain why a specific rebalancing action is recommended. It should transparently display any associated costs, potential tax implications, and how the adjustment aligns with the user’s long-term goals. Complex algorithms must be translated into simple, understandable logic.

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## Guided Goal-Setting

An onboarding experience that helps users define their risk appetite and financial goals without requiring them to understand complex financial metrics (like Alpha, Beta, or Sharpe ratios).

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## 6. JUDGING CRITERIA

Projects will be evaluated based on the following criteria:

### 30% User Experience (UX) & Empathy

How well does the solution cater to the beginner? Is the interface truly intuitive, accessible, and free of intimidating financial jargon?

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### 30% Innovation in Rebalancing

How creative and effective is the scenario-based rebalancing feature? Does it accurately translate complex market uncertainties into simple, actionable user choices?

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### 20% Transparency & Trust

Does the platform clearly communicate risks, fees, and the rationale behind its recommendations? Does it build confidence for a novice user?

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### 20% Technical Execution & Feasibility

Is the prototype functional? Does it effectively integrate (or simulate) market data, asset allocation logic, and portfolio analytics?

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## 7. EXPECTED DELIVERABLES

- 1 A working prototype or high-fidelity interactive mockup of the platform.
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- 2 A pitch deck (maximum 10 slides) outlining the problem, the proposed solution, the target user persona, and the technical architecture.
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- 3 A live demonstration highlighting the “Scenario-Driven Rebalancing” feature in action.
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Hackathon Challenge Statement